invited approximately 80 members of the NLD to participate in the national convention process. It was obvious that the Shwe's goal was to monopolize the decision-making process within the convention. The majority of delegates were either military associates of the dictator or members of the business community, which had strong ties to the military apparatus. The NLD protested the rigged process and boycotted the convention. Ultimately, the NLD had little or no input into the framing of the constitution.

Than Shwe's main goals included convening the national convention in order to begin the process of constructing a constitution. In addition, major policy initiatives included state restructuring, centralization of the military structure, educational modifications, and a declaration of a ceasefire with the Karens. Tension remained between the tatmadaw and military intelligence. Part of this factionalism had to do with the competing personalities of Shwe and Khin Nyunt, who dually played a role in the demise of Saw Maung. Than Shwe selected Maung Aye from the Eastern Region Command to serve as his new military chief. A more direct challenge to Khin Nyunt came from the fact that Shwe did not appoint him vice chairman of party. This move made it clear to everyone following the process that a rivalry was underway. As a way to cloak his conservative agenda, Than Shwe made initial policy steps in order to be perceived as more of a moderate. For example, political prisoners were released and international organizations such as the International Red Cross and Amnesty International were once again allowed to return to Myanmar. Possibly the most promising sign was Shwe's initial crackdown against corruption within the government.

These early moves may have been implemented to help Than Shwe consolidate power. Nyunt may have had more support in the cabinet. This rift at times spilled over into policy debates. On issues ranging from the speed and intent of the national convention to how to effectively deal with the NLD and Aung San Suu Kyi, to issues of foreign policy, this spilt within the government had significant ramifications.

WHAT'S IN A NAME: FROM SLORC TO SPDC

SLORC decided that in order to reconfigure the regime's image, a name change was necessary. The government had employed two public-relations